



The organisations that get this right shift from replacement planning to capability building. They create real-time visibility of talent, rotate leaders across roles, and expose them early to enterprise-level decision-making. “Succession then stops being about ‘who is next’ and becomes about ‘who is continuously being prepared,’” he says.

Sandeep Bhalla, Senior Partner & Head Consulting at business management consultant firm, Korn Ferry India, says succession challenges are fundamentally a

pipeline and readiness issue. “Too often, succession is treated as a moment in time rather than a continuous, board-led process. While organisations build functional and technical leaders effectively, far less attention is given to developing enterprise leaders who can step into CEO or C-suite roles with credibility from Day One,” he says.

What appears as a capability gap is often driven by weak pipeline building, limited cross-functional exposure, and an overestimation of who is truly ready.